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L&M Briquettes Seed Funding Proposal

Problem

As rural women cook, they spend increasing amounts of money on cooking fuel. This problem affects 10 million households in Kenya.

50% of Kenya's forests have been lost in the last 50 years. Firewood releases 150 MT of CO₂ in Kenya every day.

Solution

Our solution is briquettes. They help rural women cook more affordably.

Scalability/Innovation

There are other briquette makers, but our offering will be more affordable because briquettes are made in small units in each village, reducing on transport costs.

So, we could grow to reach the whole of Kenya.

Business Model

We'll sell each 10kg of briquettes for \$5.

Each 10kg will cost us \$2.8 to make, the cost breakdown being:

- Labourer - \$1
- Agricultural waste - \$1
- Fuel - \$0.5
- Water - \$0.3

Our monthly operations costs will total \$170, from:

- Salaries: \$100 per month
- Rent: \$50 per month
- Internet: \$20 per month

To get started, we'll also have capital expenditure of \$750 on:

- Legal Registration - \$250
- Barrels - \$150
- Manual Compressor - \$350

Social & Environmental Impact

Wider benefits of our solution's use will be less carbon emissions and deforestation. We'll measure these with:

- CO₂ reduced per briquette used (compared with firewood/charcoal)
- Reduction in use of firewood



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- \$ saved by rural women on fuel for fires.
- No. people employed at micro briquette manufacturing units.

Market Validation / Risk Mitigation

The biggest assumptions behind our venture model have been validated with the following 5+ prototyping tests:

1. Women will buy 10kg briquettes for \$5.
 - a. We've taken briquettes to 3 villages and sold 5 packets of 10kgs to customers for \$5 and gotten orders for 10 more that we couldn't fulfill.
2. The price of making briquettes is \$2.8 per 10kg.
 - a. We've made some briquettes and broken down the costs as seen above.
3. The cost of a manual compressor is \$350;
 - a. We've reached out to 3 suppliers and gotten quotations for \$350, \$400, and \$500.
4. Describe the 4th most risky assumption;
 - a. Describe the test and the results.
5. Describe the 5th most risky assumption;
 - a. Describe the test and the results.

Team

- *Leo Henghes, Email, Phone*
 - *Marketing Lead, BA in Marketing from Univeristy*
- *Max Weber Asimwe, Email, Phone*
 - *Product Design/Manufacturing, BA in Engineering and worked as an engineer for xxx company for 2 years*

Budget for Funding

We'll use the \$3,000 to cover the \$750 initial capital expenditure, and make 500 10kg of briquettes and cover 6 months of operations costs. The breakdown of the budget is:

Item Description	Cost	No. Units	Amount
Unit Costs	\$2.8	500	\$1,400
Operations Costs	\$170	5	\$850



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Capital Expenditure	\$750	1	\$750
TOTAL			\$3,000

Goals

With \$3,000, we'll track performance against the following milestones/targets:

- **Registration** - We'll register a company and open a bank account by March 2025.
- **Product Design** - We'll standardise our briquette production
- **Production & Partnerships** - We'll partner with 5 supermarkets by June.
- **Sales** - We'll sell 500 10kg of briquettes in 6 months, generating \$2,500 in revenue.